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Off days online

Planning a vacation to your favourite getaway, is just a mouse click away—A look at the facilities available to make a detailed plan for the perfect holiday

You will soon spot the swallow. Summer is near. Time to get away from the madding crowd and hang out in a hammock, and laze on your favourite turf. But planning a vacation can be hard work. Nature has given us paradise. However, instead of packing our knapsacks, we agonise over where to go, what to do, when to book the tickets, the long lines, the waiting lists...aarrggghhh!

A travel agent could make your job easy, but there's a charge attached. Here's a softer option. The Net has evolved to a position where it can hold our hands through every step. You can pick an ideal holiday spot from across the world, read up in detail about it, map out the best

routes to take, find the best ticket deals, reserve accommodation and bag the best deals—all customised to suit your tastes and needs. But how reliable and accurate is the information we find? And how far are we willing to trust cyberspace with our money?

Recent trends show that, while more and more people are availing of the resources present on the Net for research, a very insignificant number is willing to trust the Net for money transactions. Tour conductors such as Cox and Kings and Raj Travels confirm that even with a credible online presence, travellers still

Info More than 59 million travellers used the Net to make travel plans in 2000, while 25 million booked parts of their trip online

If we took a holiday

The Internet is still the best mall to shop for a perfect holiday that is determined by the money and time at hand. If you have a good two or more weeks in hand, a reasonably-priced trip can be planned for a destination abroad, or within the subcontinent—places such as Sikkim, Himachal Pradesh, Myanmar, Nepal and the Andaman-Nicobar islands hold enough to interest the tourist for a fortnight.

Almost every holiday destination in India has a tourism site that gives indepth details about the place, such as the trains and planes to take, hotel listings, the major attractions and the tourist seasons, etc. To get them all in one place, try India Tourism at <http://india-tourism.de>. Popular destinations such as Goa use Web sites such as www.goacom.com to give indepth

prefer to hold transactions in person, using their sites only for research and choosing a particular tour.

Online Vs Offline					
Advantages	Time	Convenience	Reliability	Options	Personalised attention
Online	✓	✓	✗	✓	✓
Offline	✗	✗	✓	✓	✓